



flat. So, I try not to waste my energy riding the emotions of cricket in a three-hour window. Staying neutral helps you perform your best and make good decisions.”

That balance has made her one of the most consistent batters in T20Is, with India often bearing the brunt of her performances.

In a world that celebrates flamboyance, Mooney’s steadiness has carved out its own place at the top of the rankings.

Like her former captain Meg Lanning, she too has battled the “madness of perfection”. From university classes to shifts at Woolworths as a ‘checkout chick’ and relentless training, her path has been anything but easy.

Mooney now has a century in all formats, completing the set at the MCG, where Australia won the 2020 T20 World Cup in front of a record crowd.

Her unbeaten 78 off 54 balls was overshadowed by Alyssa Healy’s 79 off 39, but for Mooney, only the win and her contribution matter.

“I don’t know if there’s really a formula (to being good in all formats). I think it would be worth a lot of money if we could come up with one, that’s for sure. I’ve been exposed to a lot of different situations and scenarios on the cricket field.

“I always go back to using that as data to show myself that I’m doing something right. Pressure is a privilege. What we face on the cricket field is nothing compared to the real problems people have outside it. It’s really easy to get caught up in how big the game is when, in fact, it’s just another 120 balls.”

Guiding light: A pillar of Australia’s golden era in women’s cricket, Beth Mooney continues to set new standards. GETTY IMAGES



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« When I am batting with her, she won’t just direct you to go after a certain bowler. So, she will keep giving ideas about how the ball is behaving, the areas that we can look to hit. So, they keep discussing these things. It is very helpful for us that we can also look at the game like that. So, you start looking at things a little differently – Harleen Deol on Mooney »